(470–540 CE), *Candrakirti* (600–50 CE) who wrote the *Prasannapada* and the *Madhyamakavatara*, and *Shantideva* (685–763 CE), author of the *Bodhicaryavatara*. *Bhavaviveka* (500–70 CE) is the most notable *Svatantrika*. He wrote the *Prajnapradipa* commentary on ***Nagarjuna***'s *Mulamadhyamika-karikas*.

Further reading: Crosby and Skilton 1996; Murti 1955; Ruegg 1981; Williams 1989 and 1998

Mala (original stain): according to most types of *Shiva*-worship, a defect which suppresses the soul's innate capacities for universal knowledge and agency and which is responsible for their subjection to the acquisition of the merit and demerit (good and bad ***karma***) that brings about bondage to a series of births.

According to ***Shaiva-Siddhanta***, it is a kind of substance (***dravya***) so can be only removed by action. Knowledge of its presence is not enough. *Mala* is likened to an ocular cataract, mere awareness of whose presence does not impair its effects and whose removal requires the action of the surgeon's instrument. The only actions that can remove it are the initiation rituals and their sequels taught by *Shiva* in the *Tantric* scriptures. *Mala* is thought of as 'ripening': at a critical point in this process, the aspirant will be moved by *Shiva*'s grace (*anugraha*) to approach the guru for initiation (*diksha*) into the cult.

Shiva creates the universe as a compassionate act for the sake of bound souls who need spheres of experience in which they may be freed from *mala* and ***karma***.

Mala provides an answer to the question of why human beings have ***karma*** and are bound to rebirth.

For those *Shiva* worshippers who believe that he is the sole reality and that all apparent differences are included in his being, basic *mala* is the limited state of awareness that is normal personality. The term is also applied to